

The Khutba sectioned

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This download contains the reviewed English translation. Numbered squares after Qur'an verses and hadiths refer to the sources section at the end.

The Muslim and the Internet: Risks and Precautions

1. Introduction (المقدمة) 2. The Beginning 3. The Content 4. Personalities 5. How do I deal with the Internet as a Muslim?

Introduction (المقدمة)

Allah, the Exalted, said: "Competition in [worldly] increase diverts you ¹ Until you visit the graveyards." ²

The meaning of competition in increase here is competition in everything. When you ride a means of transportation, when you are waiting at the doctor's, in a government department, when students are waiting for their teacher, before going to sleep and after waking up, what is the last thing your hand lets go of and the first thing it touches? It is something of what my Lord mentioned in this surah: "competition in increase" and "diverts you." Competition in increase is not only in money and possessions. My Lord also mentioned it in Surat al-Hadid. He, the Exalted, said: "Know that the life of this world is but amusement and diversion and adornment and boasting to one another and competition in increase of wealth and children - like the example of a rain whose [resulting] plant growth pleases the tillers; then it dries and you see it turned yellow; then it becomes [scattered] debris. And in the Hereafter is severe punishment and forgiveness from Allāh and approval. And what is the worldly life except the enjoyment of delusion." ³

It is addiction—but not drug addiction. It is the virtual world: the Internet and its derivatives—Snapchat, WhatsApp, TikTok, and YouTube. It is the mobile phone, the computer, and the iPad.

The Beginning

When the Internet was invented in the 1960s, no one imagined that people's lives would become captive to it and meaningless without it. Indeed, it has become one of the things to which people become addicted because of their intense attachment to it.

Psychology is still under the impact of the shock, and to this day this phenomenon of addiction has not been subjected to psychological studies and clinical research—"experiments"—in a manner commensurate with the scale of the phenomenon.

Pathological attachment and negative dependence on Internet derivatives such as Facebook, Twitter, and so on, as well as the films and games offered on the network, are a form of addiction in which the addict feels that he has no existence except with it and through it. Concern for the self and care for one's surroundings disappear before him.

The Content

I have not come today to talk to you about the benefits of the Internet, such as preserving memories, conducting research, easily transferring information, and communicating with family, and so on.

Rather, I have come to explain the ugly side and the risks and precautions that Islam has also brought to light—a cry to show how far we have reached. I hope and earnestly ask that fathers and mothers listen and take serious steps in this field. My hope is that our children and young people will be guided to consume this material for the benefit of their academic and life success. My brother, 12% of the volume of electronic commerce consists of pornographic material—I mean, sexual material?

My brother, my sister, the network contains negative content—including the promotion of lies and rumors, disparaging others, and mocking them—whose full extent is known only to Allah.

It contains millions of indecent images and immoral films whose subjects are sex, violence, and drugs.

Among the crimes are fraud against banks; intercepting and stealing insurance cards; stealing telephone numbers and bank-account details; gaining access to sensitive security information; spying on individuals and eavesdropping on them in violation of the law; and exposing some people through photographs composited in Photoshop, showing them in situations offensive to taste and decency.

Personalities

Why do you post a barbecue outing with enough food to feed a city, so that hungry people see it and wish they could eat a loaf of dry bread at the aroma of this barbecue?

Have you protected yourselves against envy and resentment, breaking the hearts of the poor and making their stomachs ache?

Why do you post a picture from the gym displaying your muscles and pictures of the sea displaying your nakedness? Have you protected yourselves against being a temptation (الفتنه) for others through you?

Why do you post a video or picture of family happiness that may not be real? Have you felt safe from envy, the ruin of homes, and the jealousy of others?

Why do you seclude yourself as a married or unmarried young man or woman, watching sexual excess, acting, and the manipulation of your desires, leading you to hate your wife or hate your husband?

Do you not know that Allah sees you? How many homes have been ruined because of these films and scenes? Do you feel safe from Allah's decisive response to wrongful plotting (المكر)? Do you think that what you conceal from people is hidden from Allah?

5 — How should I, as a Muslim, deal with this medium?

First: Do not publish or repeat what you have no knowledge (العلم) of, because it is false. Allah says: “And do not pursue that of which you have no knowledge. Indeed, the hearing, the sight and the heart - about all those [one] will be questioned.” ⁴

The two Shaykhs narrated from Ibn Mas‘ūd that the Messenger of Allah (الرسول), peace and blessings be upon him, said: “and the person who keeps telling lies and endeavours to tell a lie is recorded as a liar with Allah.” ⁵

Abū Hurayrah reported that the Messenger of Allah (الرسول), peace and blessings be upon him, said: “Avoid suspicion, for suspicion is the gravest lie in talk.” ⁶

Thus, transmission (النقل) and publication without careful verification (التثبت) constitute unfounded negative suspicion (الظن سوء) and lying. Among the gravest examples of this is what the Prophet related about his vision, in the hadith (الحديث) of Samurah in al-Bukhārī, where the Messenger of Allah (الرسول), peace and blessings be upon him, said: “The Prophet (ﷺ) said, "I saw (in a dream), two men came to me." Then the Prophet (ﷺ) narrated the story (saying), "They said, 'The person, the one whose cheek you saw being torn away (from the mouth to the ear) was a liar and used to tell lies and the people would report those lies on his authority till they spread all over the world. So he will be punished like that till the Day of Resurrection.'” ⁷

Second: Do not gloat over or ridicule others:

Allah Most High says: “O you who have believed, let not a people ridicule [another] people; perhaps they may be better than them; nor let women ridicule [other] women; perhaps they may be better than them. And do not insult one another and do not call each other by [offensive] nicknames. Wretched is the name [i.e., mention] of disobedience after [one's] faith. And whoever does not repent - then it is those who are the wrongdoers.” ⁸ This is because of an action or word that one of them did or said, which then becomes material for laughter. This indicates poor character and weak religious restraint (الدين) among Internet addicts.

Third: Do not spread immorality or look at it,

because Allah Most High says: “Indeed, those who like that immorality should be spread [or publicized] among those who have believed will have a painful punishment in this world and the Hereafter. And Allāh knows and you do not know.” ⁹

The danger of the Internet and its addicts grows through the circulation of pornographic pictures and films. These attract the attention of different segments and varying age groups of both sexes. Allah has prohibited everything that leads to them and has closed the doors because of their danger—from the initial glance until falling into them by any means.

He Most High says: “Tell the believing men to reduce [some] of their vision and guard their private parts. That is purer for them. Indeed, Allāh is [fully] Aware of what they do.” ¹⁰ And:

“And tell the believing women to reduce [some] of their vision and guard their private parts ¹¹ and not expose their adornment except that which [necessarily] appears thereof”—thus, from viewing it to: “And do not approach unlawful sexual intercourse. Indeed, it is ever an immorality and is evil as a way.”

The two Shaykhs narrated from Abu Hurayrah that the Messenger (الرسول) of Allah ﷺ said: “A share of fornication (الزنا) has been decreed for the son of Adam, and he will inevitably attain it. The two eyes commit zina, and their zina is looking; the two ears commit zina, and their zina is listening; the two hands commit zina, and their zina is seizing; the two legs commit zina, and their zina is walking. The heart wishes and desires, and the private part (الفرج) either confirms that or denies it.”

The meaning of the private part confirming or denying it is that, if the private part commits zina, it has confirmed the zina of the other limbs; but if a person preserves himself and remains safe, it has denied the zina of the other limbs.

One of the righteous said: “What is worse than the sin is publicizing it among people.”

Fourth: Where is Allah in relation to you?

Allah, the Most High, says: “And We have already created man and know (العليم) what his soul whispers to him, and We are closer to him than [his] jugular vein.” ¹²

“He knows that which deceives the eyes and what the breasts conceal.” ¹³ “Have you not considered that Allāh knows what is in the heavens and what is on the earth? There are not three in a private conversation ¹⁴ (النجوى) but that He is the fourth of them, nor are there five but that He is the sixth of them - and no less than that and no more except that He is with them [in knowledge] wherever they are. Then He will inform them of what they did, on the Day of Resurrection. Indeed Allāh is, of all things, Knowing.”

Ibn al-Jawzi, in *Ṣifat al-Ṣafwah*, mentioned this story from Nāfi‘, the client (المولى) of Ibn ‘Umar:

“I went out with Ibn ‘Umar in one of the outskirts of Medina, accompanied by some of his companions. They spread out a tablecloth, and a shepherd passed by. ‘Abdullah said to him, ‘Come, shepherd, partake of this meal.’ He replied, ‘I am fasting.’ ‘Abdullah said to him, ‘On a day such as this, with its intense heat, while you are in these ravines, among these mountains, tending these sheep—and you are fasting?’ The shepherd replied, ‘I am making haste to make up for my past days.’ Ibn ‘Umar was amazed and said, ‘Would you sell us one of your sheep so that we could slaughter it and feed you some of its meat as much as you wish, and give you its price?’ He said, ‘They do not belong to me; they belong to my master.’ He said, ‘And what could your master say if you told him that the wolf had eaten it?’ The shepherd went on, raising his finger toward the sky and saying, ‘Then where is Allah?’ Ibn ‘Umar kept saying, ‘The shepherd said: “Then where is Allah?”’ As soon as he arrived in Medina, he sent for his master, bought the shepherd and the sheep from him, then freed the shepherd and gave him the sheep. May Allah have mercy on him.”

A man came to 'Abdullah ibn al-Mubarak and said, "Advise me." He said, "Be watchful of Allah." The man asked, "What is watchfulness (المراقبة) of Allah?" He replied, "That you feel shy before Allah." Watchfulness of Allah is a treatment for many psychological and social illnesses, and it is an expression of the meaning conveyed by the Prophetic definition of spiritual and moral excellence (الإحسان): "He said: "It is to worship Allah as if you are seeing Him; and although you do not see Him, He sees you.""¹⁵

Fifth: Spread goodness, peace (السلام), and values throughout human society.

So spread values, truth (الحق), justice, and beauty; repel [evil] by that [deed] which is better; and ¹⁶ know that the good and the bad are not equal: "And not equal are the good deed and the bad. Repel [evil] by that [deed] which is better; and thereupon, the one whom between you and him is enmity [will become] as though he was a devoted friend (الولي)."

Finally, be moderate and preserve your time.

Sources and glossary

Each numbered source below matches the square carrying the same number in the sermon.

Qur'an and hadith sources

1 Qur'an: At-Takathur 102:1

Canonical English: Competition in [worldly] increase diverts you

English transliteration: Alhakumu attakathur

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أَلْهَكُمُ التَّكَاثُرُ

2 Qur'an: At-Takathur 102:2

Canonical English: Until you visit the graveyards

English transliteration: Hatta zurtumu almaqabir

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حَتَّىٰ زُرْتُمُ الْمَقَابِرَ

3 Qur'an: Al-Hadid 57:20

Canonical English: Know that the life of this world is but amusement and diversion and adornment and boasting to one another and competition in increase of wealth and children - like the example of a rain whose [resulting] plant growth pleases the tillers; then it dries and you see it turned yellow; then it becomes [scattered] debris. And in the Hereafter is severe punishment and forgiveness from Allāh and approval. And what is the worldly life except the enjoyment of delusion

English transliteration: IAAalamoo annama alhayatuaddunya laAAaibun walahwun wazeenatun watafakhurunbaynakum watakathurun fee al-amwali wal-awladikamathali ghaythin aAAajaba alkuffara nabatuhuthumma yaheeju fatarahu musfarran thumma yakoonu hutamanwafee al-akhirati AAathabun shadeedun wamaghfiratunmina Allahi waridwanun wama alhayatuaddunya illa mataAAu alghuroor

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أَعْلَمُوا أَنَّمَا الْحَيَاةُ الدُّنْيَا لَعِبٌ وَلَهُمْ زِينَةٌ وَتَفَاخُرٌ بَيْنَكُمْ وَتَكَاثُرٌ فِي الْأُمُولِ وَالْأَوْلَادِ كَمَثَلِ غَيْثٍ أَعْجَبَ الْكُفَّارَ تَبَاتُهُ ثُمَّ يَهِيجُ فَتَرَاهُ مُصْفَرًّا ثُمَّ يَكُونُ حُطَمًا وَفِي الْآخِرَةِ عَذَابٌ شَدِيدٌ وَمَغْفِرَةٌ مِّنَ اللَّهِ وَرِضْوَانٌ وَمَا الْحَيَاةُ الدُّنْيَا إِلَّا مَتَاعُ الْعُرُورِ

4 Qur'an: Al-Isra 17:36

Canonical English: And do not pursue that of which you have no knowledge. Indeed, the hearing, the sight and the heart - about all those [one] will be questioned

English transliteration: Wala taqfu ma laysa laka bihiAAailmun inna assamAAa walbasara walfu-adakullu ola-ika kana AAanhu mas-oola

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وَلَا تَقْفُ مَا لَيْسَ لَكَ بِهِ عِلْمٌ إِنَّ السَّمْعَ وَالْبَصَرَ وَالْفُؤَادَ كُلُّ أُولَٰئِكَ كَانَ عَنْهُ مَسْئُولًا

5 Hadith: Sahih Muslim 2607c

Canonical English: and the person who keeps telling lies and endeavours to tell a lie is recorded as a liar with Allah

English transliteration: Ḥaddathanā Muḥammad ibn ‘Abd Allāh ibn Numayr, ḥaddathanā Abū Mu‘āwiyah, wa-Wakī, qālā ḥaddathanā al-A‘maṣh, ḥā’ wa-ḥaddathanā Abū Kurayb, ḥaddathanā Abū Mu‘āwiyah, ḥaddathanā al-A‘maṣh, ‘an Shaqīq, ‘an ‘Abd Allāh, qāla qāla Rasūl Allāh ṣallā Allāhu ‘alayhi wa-sallam: ‘alaykum bi-l-ṣidq fa-inna al-ṣidq yahdī ilā al-birr wa-inna al-birr yahdī ilā al-jannah wa-mā yazālu al-rajul yaṣduq wa-yataḥarrā al-ṣidq ḥattā yuktab ‘inda Allāh ṣiddīqan wa-iyyakum wa-al-kadhib fa-inna al-kadhib yahdī ilā al-fujūr wa-inna al-fujūr yahdī ilā al-nār wa-mā yazālu al-rajul yakdhib wa-yataḥarrā al-kadhib ḥattā yuktab ‘inda Allāh kadhdhāban.

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حَدَّثَنَا مُحَمَّدُ بْنُ عَبْدِ اللَّهِ بْنِ تَمِيمٍ، حَدَّثَنَا أَبُو مُعَاوِيَةَ، وَوَكَيْعٌ، قَالَا حَدَّثَنَا الْأَعْمَشُ، ح وَحَدَّثَنَا أَبُو كُرَيْبٍ، حَدَّثَنَا أَبُو مُعَاوِيَةَ، حَدَّثَنَا الْأَعْمَشُ، عَنْ شَقِيقٍ، عَنْ عَبْدِ اللَّهِ، قَالَ قَالَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ عَلَيْكُمْ بِالصِّدْقِ فَإِنَّ الصِّدْقَ يَهْدِي إِلَى الْبِرِّ وَإِنَّ الْبِرَّ يَهْدِي إِلَى الْجَنَّةِ وَمَا يَزَالُ الرَّجُلُ يَصْدُقُ وَيَتَحَرَّى الصِّدْقَ حَتَّى يُكْتَبَ عِنْدَ اللَّهِ صِدِّيقًا وَإِيَّاكُمْ وَالْكَذِبَ فَإِنَّ الْكَذِبَ يَهْدِي إِلَى الْفُجُورِ وَإِنَّ الْفُجُورَ يَهْدِي إِلَى النَّارِ وَمَا يَزَالُ الرَّجُلُ يَكْذِبُ وَيَتَحَرَّى الْكَذِبَ حَتَّى يُكْتَبَ عِنْدَ اللَّهِ كَذَابًا .

6 Hadith: Sahih Muslim 2563a

Canonical English: Avoid suspicion, for suspicion is the gravest lie in talk

English transliteration: Ḥaddathanā Yaḥyā ibn Yaḥyā, qāla qara‘tu ‘alā Mālik ‘an Abī al-Zinād, ‘an al-A‘raj, ‘an Abī Hurayrah, anna Rasūl Allāh ṣallā Allāhu ‘alayhi wa-sallam qāla: iyyākum wa-al-ẓann fa-inna al-ẓann akdhab al-ḥadīth wa-lā taḥassasū wa-lā tajassasū wa-lā tanāfasū wa-lā taḥāsadū wa-lā tabāghaḍū wa-lā tadābarū wa-kūnū ‘ibād Allāh ikh wānan.

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حَدَّثَنَا يَحْيَى بْنُ يَحْيَى، قَالَ قَرَأْتُ عَلَى مَالِكٍ عَنْ أَبِي الزِّنَادِ، عَنِ الْأَعْرَجِ، عَنْ أَبِي هُرَيْرَةَ، أَنَّ رَسُولَ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ قَالَ إِيَّاكُمْ وَالظَّنَّ فَإِنَّ الظَّنَّ أَكْذَبُ الْحَدِيثِ وَلَا تَحَسَّسُوا وَلَا تَجَسَّسُوا وَلَا تَنَافَسُوا وَلَا تَحَاسَدُوا وَلَا تَبَاغَضُوا وَلَا تَدَابَرُوا وَكُونُوا عِبَادَ اللَّهِ إِخْوَانًا .

7 Hadith: Sahih al-Bukhari 6096

Canonical English: The Prophet () said, "I saw (in a dream), two men came to me." Then the Prophet () narrated the story (saying), "They said, 'The person, the one whose cheek you saw being torn away (from the mouth to the ear) was a liar and used to tell lies and the people would report those lies on his authority till they spread all over the world. So he will be punished like that till the Day of Resurrection

English transliteration: Ḥaddathanā Mūsā ibn Ismā‘īl, ḥaddathanā Jarīr, ḥaddathanā Abū Rajā’, ‘an Samurah ibn Jundub, raḍiya Allāhu ‘anhu, qāla qāla al-Nabī ṣallā Allāhu ‘alayhi wa-sallam: ra’aytu rajulayn atayānī qālā alladhī ra’aytahu yushaqqu shidquhu fa-kadhdhāb yakdhib bi-al-kadhibah tuḥmal ‘anhu ḥattā tablugha al-āfaq fa-yuṣna’ bihi ilā yawm al-qiyāmah.

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حَدَّثَنَا مُوسَى بْنُ إِسْمَاعِيلَ، حَدَّثَنَا جَرِيرٌ، حَدَّثَنَا أَبُو رَجَاءٍ، عَنْ سَمُرَةَ بْنِ جُنْدُبٍ - رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ - قَالَ قَالَ النَّبِيُّ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ رَأَيْتُ رَجُلَيْنِ أَتَيَانِي قَالَا الَّذِي رَأَيْتَهُ يُشَقُّ شِدْقُهُ فَكَذَابٌ يَكْذِبُ بِالْكَذِبَةِ تَحْمَلُ عَنْهُ حَتَّى تَبْلُغَ الْأَفَاقَ فَيُصْنَعُ بِهِ إِلَى يَوْمِ الْقِيَامَةِ .

8 Qur'an: Al-Hujurat 49:11

Canonical English: O you who have believed, let not a people ridicule [another] people; perhaps they may be better than them; nor let women ridicule [other] women; perhaps they may be better than them. And do not insult one another and do not call each other by [offensive] nicknames. Wretched is the name [i.e., mention] of disobedience after [one's] faith. And whoever does not repent - then it is those who are the wrongdoers

English transliteration: Ya ayyuha allatheena amanoola yaskhar qawmun min qawmin AAasa an yakoonookhayran minhum wala nisaon min nisa-in AAasaan yakunna khayran minhunna wala talmizoo anfusakum walatanabazoo bil-alqabi bi/sa al-ismualfusooqu baAAada al-eemani waman lam yatub faola-ikahumu aththalimoon

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يَا أَيُّهَا الَّذِينَ ءَامَنُوا لَا يَسْخَر قَوْمٌ مِّن قَوْمٍ عَسَىٰ أَن يَكُونُوا خَيْرًا مِّنْهُمْ وَلَا نِسَاءٌ مِّن نِّسَاءٍ عَسَىٰ أَن يَكُن خَيْرًا مِّنْهُنَّ وَلَا تَلْمِزُوا أَنفُسَكُمْ وَلَا تَنَابَزُوا بِالْأَلْقَابِ بِئْسَ الْأَسْمُ الْقَسُوفَ بَعْدَ الْإِيمَانِ وَمَن لَّمْ يَتُب فَأُولَٰئِكَ هُم الظَّالِمُونَ

9 Qur'an: An-Nur 24:19

Canonical English: Indeed, those who like that immorality should be spread [or publicized] among those who have believed will have a painful punishment in this world and the Hereafter. And Allāh knows and you do not know

English transliteration: Inna allatheena yuhibboona antasheeAAa alfahishatu fee allatheena amanoolahum AAathabun aleemun fee addunya wal-akhiratiwallahu yaAAalamu waantum la taAAalamoon

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إِنَّ الَّذِينَ يُحِبُّونَ أَن تَشِيعَ الْفَاحِشَةُ فِي الَّذِينَ ءَامَنُوا لَهُمْ عَذَابٌ أَلِيمٌ فِي الدُّنْيَا وَالْآخِرَةِ ۗ وَاللَّهُ يَعْلَمُ وَأَنتُمْ لَا تَعْلَمُونَ

10 Qur'an: An-Nur 24:30

Canonical English: Tell the believing men to reduce [some] of their vision and guard their private parts. That is purer for them. Indeed, Allāh is [fully] Aware of what they do

English transliteration: Qul lilmu/mineena yaghuddoo min absarihumwayahfathoo furoojahum thalika azkalahum inna Allaha khabeerun bima yasnaAAoon

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قُلْ لِّلْمُؤْمِنِينَ يَغُضُّوْا مِنْ أَبْصَارِهِمْ وَيَحْفَظُوْا فُرُوْجَهُمْ ذٰلِكَ اَزْكٰى لَهُمْ ۗ اِنَّ اللّٰهَ خَبِيْرٌۢ بِمَا يَصْنَعُوْنَ

11 Qur'an: An-Nur 24:31

Canonical English: to reduce [some] of their vision and guard their private parts

English transliteration: Waqul ilmu/minati yaghdudnamin absarihinna wayahfathnafuroojahunna wala yubdeena zeenatahunna illa mathahara minha walyadribnakhumurihinna AAala juyoobihinna wala yubdeenazeenatahunna illa libuAAoolatihinna aw aba-ihinnaaw aba-i buAAoolatihinna aw abna-ihinna awabna-i buAAoolatihinna aw ikhwanihinna aw baneeikhwanihinna aw banee akhawatihinna aw nisa-ihinnaaw ma malakat aymanuhunna awi attabiAAeenaghayri olee al-irbati mina arrijali awi attifliallatheena lam yathharoo AAala AAawratiannisa-i wala yadribnabi-arjulihinna liyuAAlama ma yukhfeena min zeenatihinnawatooboo ila Allahi jameeAAan ayyuhaalmu/minoona laAAaallakum tuflihoon

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وَقُلْ لِلْمُؤْمِنَاتِ يَغْضُضْنَ مِنْ أَبْصَارِهِنَّ وَيَحْفَظْنَ فُرُوجَهُنَّ وَلَا يُبْدِينَ زِينَتَهُنَّ إِلَّا مَا ظَهَرَ مِنْهَا وَلْيَضْرِبْنَ بِخُمُرِهِنَّ عَلَىٰ جُيُوبِهِنَّ وَلَا يُبْدِينَ زِينَتَهُنَّ إِلَّا لِبُعُولَتِهِنَّ أَوْ آبَائِهِنَّ أَوْ آبَاءَ بُعُولَتِهِنَّ أَوْ أَبْنَاءِهِنَّ أَوْ أَبْنَاءَ بُعُولَتِهِنَّ أَوْ إِخْوَانَهُنَّ أَوْ بَنِي أَخَوَاتِهِنَّ أَوْ نِسَائِهِنَّ أَوْ مَا مَلَكَتْ أَيْمَانُهُنَّ أَوِ التَّيَّعِينَ غَيْرَ أُولَىٰ الرَّبِّةِ مِنَ الرِّجَالِ أَوْ الْوَلَدَ الَّذِي لَمْ يَظْهَرُوا عَلَىٰ عَوْرَتِ النِّسَاءِ وَلَا يَضْرِبْنَ بِأَرْجُلِهِنَّ لِيُعْلَمَ مَا يُخْفِينَ مِنْ زِينَتِهِنَّ وَتُوبُوا إِلَى اللَّهِ جَمِيعًا أَيُّهَ الْمُؤْمِنُونَ لَعَلَّكُمْ تُفْلِحُونَ

12 Qur'an: Qaf 50:16

Canonical English: And We have already created man and know what his soul whispers to him, and We are closer to him than [his] jugular vein.

English transliteration: Walaqad khalaqna al-insanawanaAAlamu ma tuwaswisu bihi nafsuhu wanahnu aqrabuilayhi min habli alwareed

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وَلَقَدْ خَلَقْنَا الْإِنْسَانَ وَنَعْلَمُ مَا تُوَسْوِسُ بِهِ نَفْسُهُ وَنَحْنُ أَقْرَبُ إِلَيْهِ مِنْ حَبْلِ الْوَرِيدِ

13 Qur'an: Ghafir 40:19

Canonical English: He knows that which deceives the eyes and what the breasts conceal

English transliteration: YaAAlamu kha-inata al-aAAayuni wamatukhfee assudoor

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يَعْلَمُ خَائِنَةَ الْأَعْيُنِ وَمَا تُخْفِي الصُّدُورُ

14 Qur'an: Al-Mujadila 58:7

Canonical English: Have you not considered that Allāh knows what is in the heavens and what is on the earth? There are not three in a private conversation

English transliteration: Alam tara anna Allaha yaAAlamu mafee assamawati wama fee al-ardima yakoonu min najwa thalathatin illahuwa rabiAAahum wala khamsatin illa huwa sadisuhumwala adna min thalika wala aktharaila huwa maAAahum ayna ma kanoo thummayunabbi-ohum bima AAamiloo yawma alqiyamati innaAllaha bikulli shay-in AAaleem

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أَلَمْ تَرَ أَنَّ اللَّهَ يَعْلَمُ مَا فِي السَّمَوَاتِ وَمَا فِي الْأَرْضِ مَا يَكُونُ مِنْ تَحْوَى ثَلَاثَةٍ إِلَّا هُوَ رَابِعُهُمْ وَلَا خَمْسَةٍ إِلَّا هُوَ سَادُسُهُمْ وَلَا ادْتَىٰ مِنْ ذَلِكَ وَلَا أَكْثَرَ إِلَّا هُوَ مَعَهُمْ أَيْنَ مَا كَانُوا ثُمَّ يُنَبِّئُهُم بِمَا عَمِلُوا يَوْمَ الْقِيَمَةِ إِنَّ اللَّهَ بِكُلِّ شَيْءٍ عَلِيمٌ

15 Hadith: Sahih Muslim 8a

Canonical English: He said: "It is to worship Allah as if you are seeing Him; and although you do not see Him, He sees you

English transliteration: Qāla: an taʿbuda Allāha ka-annaka tarāhu fa-in lam takun tarāhu fa-innahu yarāka

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قال «أَنْ تَعْبُدَ اللَّهَ كَأَنَّكَ تَرَاهُ فَإِنْ لَمْ تَكُن تَرَاهُ فَإِنَّهُ يَرَاكَ».

16 Qur'an: Fussilat 41:34

Canonical English: repel [evil] by that [deed] which is better; and

English transliteration: Wala tastawee alhasanatu walaassayyi-atu idfaAA billatee hiya ahsanufa-itha allathe baynaka wabaynahu AAadawatunkaannahu waliyyun hameem

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وَلَا تَسْتَوِي الْحَسَنَةُ وَلَا السَّيِّئَةُ ادْفَعْ بِالَّتِي هِيَ أَحْسَنُ فَإِذَا الَّذِي بَيْنَكَ وَبَيْنَهُ عَدَاوَةٌ كَأَنَّهُ وَلِيٌّ حَمِيمٌ

Glossary

Introduction

Meaning: The opening section that prepares the sermon's theme. In classical khutbah it often includes praise, testimony, and blessings.

Literal translation: introduction

Other contexts: Logic: premise; spatial context: front/vanguard.

المَقْدَمَة

temptation

Meaning: A context-dependent term for a test, temptation, persecution, destabilizing trial, punishment, or civil strife. Its central image is a process that exposes or tests what is genuine.

Literal translation: temptation

Other contexts: Attraction context: fascination; captivating charm.

الْفِتْنَة

plotting

Meaning: Secretly arranging an outcome through means the other party does not perceive. When attributed to Allah, it denotes His decisive response to wrongful plotting, not moral deceit.

Literal translation: plotting

المَكْر

knowledge

Meaning: The All-Knowing without limit or acquisition. It denotes complete, timeless, and unfailing knowledge.

Literal translation: know; learn

الْعِلْم

knowledge

Meaning: Knowledge based on sound evidence and understanding. In religious sermons, it often refers to sacred or beneficial knowledge rather than modern science specifically.

Literal translation: science

Other contexts: Different vocalization (): flag; identifying banner.

الْعِلْم

Allah Meaning: A messenger commissioned by Allah to convey revelation. The word can refer to a human or angelic messenger, depending on context. Literal translation: apostle	
	الرسول
hadith Meaning: A transmitted report about the Prophet's words, actions, approvals, or attributes. Calling a report "hadith" identifies its genre, not its level of authenticity. Literal translation: conversation Other contexts: Adjectival context: modern; recent.	
	الحديث
transmission Meaning: Authoritative transmission of text or report. It contrasts with pure reasoning and refers to transmitted evidence. Literal translation: transport	
	النقل
careful verification Meaning: Careful verification before accepting or acting on information. It means checking truth and avoiding haste, especially regarding reports. Literal translation: steadiness	
	التثبت
unfounded negative suspicion Meaning: Unfounded negative suspicion about Allah or other people. It can concern divine wisdom, another person's motives, or social conduct and must be understood from context. Literal translation: negative thinking	
	سوء الظن
restraint Meaning: The divinely ordained way of faith, worship, ethics, and accountability. Depending on context, the same word can also mean judgment or recompense. Literal translation: religion Other contexts: Different vocalization (): debt; an obligation owed.	
	الدين
peace Meaning: The One free from every defect and the source of safety and peace. As a divine name, it means more than tranquillity. Literal translation: peace Other contexts: Everyday usage: greeting of peace; salutation.	
	السلام

private conversation Meaning: Private conversation or secret counsel. Qur'anic usage can refer positively to intimate supplication or negatively to concealed plotting. Literal translation: whisper	
	النجوى
client Meaning: The Patron, Master, Protector, or Ally. It is a relational term whose exact English rendering depends on who is speaking and the surrounding context. Literal translation: master Other contexts: Historical social context: client/freedman; patron.	
	المولى
watchfulness Meaning: Living with sustained awareness that Allah observes and knows all things. It is a spiritual practice of accountability, not surveillance of other people. Literal translation: monitoring	
	المراقبة
spiritual and moral excellence Meaning: Spiritual and moral excellence, especially worshipping Allah with deep awareness and treating creation well. It is broader than ordinary kindness. Literal translation: kindness	
	الإحسان
truth Meaning: Truth, a valid claim, an entitlement, or an established reality. Because the word is highly polysemous, divine truth and a person's legal right require different English renderings. Literal translation: right Other contexts: Theological context: al-Ḥaqq, 'the Truth/Real', a divine name.	
	الحق
friend Meaning: The Protecting Patron and Ally who is near to His servants. The word can combine protection, authority, loyalty, and closeness, so "friend" is too weak. Literal translation: friend Other contexts: Family/legal context: guardian; person with legal authority.	
	الولي